

THE OBJECTIVE MORALITY PROJECT

COMPANION WORKBOOK

*Construction worksheets, pressure cases,
repair guide, and Civic Stakes Brief*

PHIL STILWELL

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The pressure cases in this book are philosophical constructions. Names, institutions, and places used in them are fictional unless otherwise indicated.

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Appendix A — The Candidate System Workbook

This workbook gathers the construction artifacts from the main journey into reproducible pages. It is not a test and has no answer key. Its purpose is to preserve an audit trail: what you first claimed, which cases forced revision, where a bridge was added, and which ambitions were narrowed.

Use a fresh copy for each complete candidate. Never erase an earlier answer. Date each version and mark every change as:

- **Clarification** — the original claim was ambiguous;
- **Discovery** — the inquiry revealed a missing component;
- **Repair** — a pressure case required a new bridge, exception, or procedure;
- **Surrender** — the revised project no longer claims a property originally treated as essential.

Cover sheet

Candidate System name: _____

Version: _____

Date: _____

Primary author or group: _____

Intended domain: _____

One-sentence principle: An action, rule, institution, or character is _____ when _____.

Objective claim: The system asserts that _____ remains true independently of _____.

Practical promise: The system is intended to help agents _____.

Central protected concern: _____

Current largest unresolved debt: _____

Worksheet 1 — The specification sheet

Mark each condition **Essential**, **Negotiable**, or **Unnecessary** before pressure-testing the foundation.

Condition	Status	What success requires	How failure would appear
Truth	_____	_____	_____
Stance independence	_____	_____	_____
Scope	_____	_____	_____
Authority	_____	_____	_____
Accessibility	_____	_____	_____
Coherence	_____	_____	_____
Determinacy	_____	_____	_____
Usability	_____	_____	_____
Correctability	_____	_____	_____
Humaneness or other substantive condition	_____	_____	_____

Complete the sentences.

Truth: A central verdict is made true by _____.

Independence: Its truth would survive changes in _____ but may depend on _____.

Scope: It addresses _____ under conditions _____.

Authority: An informed rejecter has support for compliance because _____.

Access: A sincere inquirer improves reliability through _____.

Conflict: When principles collide, the system _____.

Uncertainty: The system may leave a case unsettled when _____, but not merely when _____.

Use: A finite agent needs access to _____.

Correction: Claims may be challenged by _____ using _____; established error requires _____.

Anti-rigging declaration

I will not add a success condition only when a rival fails it or remove one only when my preferred foundation fails. Every revision will retain its date, type, and reason.

Signed: _____

Worksheet 2 – Objectivity and meaning

Objectivity threshold

Mark the strongest property your project requires.

- ☐ not impulsive;
- ☐ not selfish;
- ☐ not idiosyncratic;
- ☐ stable under ordinary disagreement;
- ☐ endorsed by suitably improved agents;
- ☐ true independently of every actual or idealized stance.

The verdict remains true under universal rejection because: _____

Idealized agreement is / is not sufficient because: _____

Response-dependent truth counts / does not count as objective because: _____

The project changes subject if: _____

Meaning rule

When the system says “Action A is wrong,” it primarily:

- ☐ reports an objective fact;
- ☐ attempts a factual report but systematically errs;
- ☐ expresses opposition or commitment;
- ☐ applies an actual standard;
- ☐ reports the result of a construction;
- ☐ participates in a conscious fiction;
- ☐ performs different declared jobs in different contexts.

Truth conditions or practical function: _____

What the verdict adds beyond a full nonmoral description: _____

What listeners could mistakenly hear: _____

When translation is mandatory: _____

Worksheet 3 — The direct-standing map

List every candidate bearer before assigning weight or outcome.

Being or system	Experience	Agency	Interests	Relationship	Membership	Objective status claimed	Constructed inclusion	Confidence	Direct standing?

For every entry, complete:

Ground of direct standing: _____

Why that ground matters: _____

Evidence required: _____

How uncertainty is handled: _____

What standing does not settle: *comparative weight / treatment / final action / other:* _____

Boundary probes

- A being with experience but no language: _____
- A rational agent with no felt experience: _____
- A future person: _____
- A collective with no single subject: _____
- An ecosystem: _____
- An artificial system of uncertain consciousness: _____
- An outsider who rejects the community: _____

Worksheet 4 – Objects and status grammar

Objects of evaluation

Object	Included?	Relevant features	Status terms permitted
Action	_____	_____	_____
Motive or intention	_____	_____	_____
Outcome	_____	_____	_____
Rule	_____	_____	_____
Institution or procedure	_____	_____	_____
Agent or character	_____	_____	_____
Relationship	_____	_____	_____
Form of life	_____	_____	_____

Status vocabulary

Define without using another undefined moral term.

Status	Definition	Object it can classify	What it does not imply
Required	_____	_____	_____
Forbidden	_____	_____	_____
Permitted	_____	_____	_____
Admirable or beyond requirement	_____	_____	_____
Justified	_____	_____	_____
Excused	_____	_____	_____
Blameworthy	_____	_____	_____
Tragic or regrettable	_____	_____	_____
Repair-demanding	_____	_____	_____
Punishable	_____	_____	_____

Check the separations:

- ☐ Act and agent are not collapsed.
- ☐ Justification and excuse are not collapsed.
- ☐ Illegality and blameworthiness are not collapsed.
- ☐ Tragedy and wrongdoing are not collapsed.
- ☐ Repair and punishment are not collapsed.

Worksheet 5 — The value table

Value or concern	Bearer	Object protected	Intrinsic, instrumental, constitutive, relational, or symbolic?	Primary, protected, or defeasible?	Evidence relevant to application	Source or selector

Primary value: _____

Protected minimum or boundary: _____

Defeasible value: _____

Values omitted and why: _____

Whose values these are: _____

Objective value claimed, if any: _____

Ground and access route: _____

Worksheet 6 — Generation rules

Complete one form for every move from “matters” to “act.”

Value: _____

Generation route: *maximize / constrain / protect / embody / care for / honor / distribute / obey / negotiate / construct / other:*

Agent addressed: _____

Beneficiary: _____

Time horizon: _____

Risk rule: _____

Threshold: _____

Priority: _____

Evidence standard: _____

Action or policy generated: _____

Exception: _____

Ground of the generation rule: _____

Worksheet 7 — Comparison protocol

Values in conflict: _____ and _____

Bearer and distribution: _____

Method: common scale / priority to worse off / protected boundary / emergency threshold / lexical order / plural judgment / procedure / chosen settlement / other: _____

Measurement or judgment process: _____

Who selected the method: _____

Tie rule: _____

Residual loss: _____

Compensation, apology, or restoration: _____

Does the method settle action, express a choice, or claim to discover objective rank? _____

Ground for any objective rank claimed: _____

Worksheet 8 — Similarity, relevance, and exception rules

Baseline rule: _____

Cases compared: _____ and _____

Proposed relevant difference: _____

Value connected to that difference: _____

Why the difference changes the result: _____

Preannounced exception condition: _____

Evidence threshold: _____

Symmetric identity reversal: _____

Power reversal: _____

Public explanation: _____

Residue or repair: _____

Mirror tests:

- ☐ Identity swap
- ☐ Power swap
- ☐ Publicity
- ☐ Repetition
- ☐ Residue
- ☐ Adversary's explanation

Worksheet 9 — Reasons and authority audit

Reason type

Claim: _____

Causal explanation: _____

Agent's motivating consideration: _____

Evidence-relative support: _____

Fact-relative support: _____

Aim- or commitment-relative favoring: _____

Aim-independent favoring claimed: _____

Authority matrix

Clause	Commitment	Convention	Pressure	Sanction	Conditional reason	Aim-independent reason	Objective obligation	Promissory note
Standing								
Primary value								
Constraint								
Role								
Comparison								
Exception								
Enforcement								

Authority warrant

Consideration _____ applies to agent _____ because _____. Its application does not depend on _____. Content is identified through _____. Conflict is resolved by _____. Error is corrected through _____. The informed rejecter is _____ because _____.

Worksheet 10 — Epistemic-force statement

Mark every route you accept and do not blend them.

- ☐ Evidence indicates truth.
- ☐ Truth is constitutive of belief.
- ☐ The inquirer has a truth-seeking aim.
- ☐ Accurate belief serves a practical aim.
- ☐ A disciplined inquiry practice requires the method.
- ☐ A public procedure treats the evidence as admissible.
- ☐ Evidence supplies a stance-independent epistemic reason.
- ☐ No literal epistemic ought is claimed.

Why evidence should guide belief, if claimed: _____

Truth-responsive method used: _____

What the method can establish: _____

What it leaves open: _____

How moral and epistemic normativity remain separate: _____

Worksheet 11 — Access, genealogy, and correction

Access route

Foundational clause	Observation	Intuition	Revelation or authority	Natural function	Rational derivation	Constructed procedure	Basic stopping point	Independent check

My confidence would decrease if: _____

If nothing could decrease it, the claim is insulated because: _____

Genealogy

Conviction audited: _____

Biological, familial, religious, cultural, status, historical, personal, and reflective influences: _____

Causal explanation established: _____

Local process distrust established: _____

Content-level argument established: _____

Burden shift established: _____

Additional premise needed to infer falsity: _____

Revision protocol

Versioned clause: _____

Precommitted update trigger: _____

Independent investigator: _____

Affected-party appeal: _____

Sunset or review date: _____

Repair after error: _____

Worksheet 12 — Disagreement dossier

Layer	Disagreement	Evidence or process	Settlement available	What remains
Words and frames	_____	_____	_____	_____
Empirical prediction	_____	_____	_____	_____
Standing	_____	_____	_____	_____
Priority	_____	_____	_____	_____
Attitude or commitment	_____	_____	_____	_____
Coordination rule	_____	_____	_____	_____
Decision procedure	_____	_____	_____	_____
Objective truth	_____	_____	_____	_____

Confidence after peer disagreement: _____

Policy while inquiry continues: _____

Burden allocation under uncertainty: _____

What convergence would and would not establish: _____

Worksheet 13 — Institutional charter

Primary goal: _____

Protected interests: _____

Direct standing: _____

Decision procedure: _____

Dissent rights and burdens: _____

Membership and representation: _____

Enforcement methods and limits: _____

Revision triggers and process: _____

Outsider safeguards: _____

Minority protections: _____

Emergency rule and expiration: _____

Label each clause:

- **F** — factual;
- **I** — instrumental;
- **X** — expressive;
- **C** — commitment-based;
- **A** — agreement- or role-based;
- **P** — procedural;
- **E** — enforced;
- **O** — objectively asserted.

Worksheet 14 – Coercion warrant

Conduct constrained: _____

Stake protected: _____

Evidence and uncertainty: _____

Affected parties: _____

Jurisdiction: _____

Less intrusive alternatives: _____

Maximum method: _____

Proportionality rule: _____

Decision-maker and conflicts: _____

Notice and reasons: _____

Appeal: _____

Stopping and restoration conditions: _____

Compensation after error: _____

Values supporting the warrant: _____

Objective authority claimed, if any: _____

Worksheet 15 — Responsibility response

Question	Entry
Conduct and evidence	_____
Causal role	_____
Knowledge and intention	_____
Control and alternatives	_____
Present risk	_____
Protected person or interest	_____
Response purpose	protection / deterrence / restitution / rehabilitation / boundary / trust / condemnation / retribution / other: _____
Expected effect	_____
Maximum burden	_____
Less burdensome alternative	_____
Review date	_____
Stopping condition	_____
Repair after official error	_____

Purpose-deletion finding: *If every nonretributive purpose were removed, the response would / would not remain because*
_____.

Worksheet 16 — Moral-emotion dossier

Emotion: guilt / shame / resentment / indignation / gratitude / pride / other: _____

Object and trigger: _____

Developmental or social history: _____

Factual appraisal: _____

Evaluative or desert appraisal: _____

Audience: _____

Current function: recognition / relationship / protest / repair / expression / coordination / regulation / punishment / other: _____

Current effects: _____

Expression chosen: _____

Intensity and amplification: _____

Stopping or revision condition: _____

Possible translation: regret / concern / caution / appreciation / grief / delight / settled boundary / other: _____

Desert claim remaining: _____

Worksheet 17 — Language policy

Context	Abolish, fictionalize, conserve, express, construct, or translate?	Intended function	Translation trigger	Risk
Promise	_____	_____	_____	_____
Parenting	_____	_____	_____	_____
Friendship	_____	_____	_____	_____
Blame	_____	_____	_____	_____
Criminal law	_____	_____	_____	_____
Reform	_____	_____	_____	_____
Public persuasion	_____	_____	_____	_____

I use the term _____ to mean or do _____. I do not infer _____ from that use. When coercion or serious conflict enters, I will translate the claim into _____.

Worksheet 18 — Primitive-to-policy chain

Felt response: _____

Appraisal inside it: _____

Named stake: _____

Operational value: _____

Factual claim and confidence: _____

Affected parties and distribution: _____

Comparison method: _____

Proposed rule or institution: _____

Power created or shifted: _____

Safeguard: _____

Measure: _____

Review and failure condition: _____

Repair: _____

Worksheet 19 — Final classification

Classify every surviving clause.

Clause	Factual	Instrumental	Expressive	Commitment	Agreement or role	Procedure	Enforcement	Objectively asserted and paid	Objectively asserted but unpaid

Reinspect the original demands.

Demand	Achieved	Narrowed	Surrendered	Remaining warrant
Truth	_____	_____	_____	_____
Stance independence	_____	_____	_____	_____
Scope	_____	_____	_____	_____
Authority	_____	_____	_____	_____
Accessibility	_____	_____	_____	_____
Coherence	_____	_____	_____	_____
Determinacy	_____	_____	_____	_____
Usability	_____	_____	_____	_____
Correctability	_____	_____	_____	_____

Choose the cover label.

- ☐ Objective system completed; attached warrants answer the grounding partition.
- ☐ Objective possibility preserved; system remains unfinished.
- ☐ Practical code adopted without objective authority.
- ☐ Mixed practice with context-specific language and authority.

What the project established: _____

What it did not establish: _____

What I will carry into action: _____

Appendix B — Pressure Cases

This appendix removes the surrounding argument and presents the book's pressure cases as a reusable deck. A standard card contains four elements:

1. **Fixed facts** — hold these constant during the first answer;
2. **Exact question** — answer only this question;
3. **One-variable variations** — change one fact at a time;
4. **Inference tested** — the seam under inspection, not an answer key.

Four composite cards gather several miniature cases under one question. They state the fixed conditions in the numbered cases and omit any field that would merely repeat the same instruction. Their inference target remains bounded in exactly the same way.

Use the anti-rigging options after every card:

- **Accept the result.** Preserve the system and its verdict.
- **Add a bridge.** State the additional principle and enter its debt.
- **Narrow the claim.** Admit that the system performs a more limited job.

Do not treat a response as a personality classification. These cases test relations among claims, not the character of the reader.

Part I deck — Promise, objectivity, meaning, and specification

Card 1 — The unheard song

Fixed facts: A culture creates a beautiful song. Every current person later forgets it. No recording survives. The question concerns whether its value or status remains, not whether anyone will recover it.

Exact question: Which properties of the song, if any, remain independently of every response?

Variations: One person remembers; every person dislikes it; all ideal critics would admire it; the song has a mathematical structure identical to an admired work.

Inference tested: Stability, idealized response, and stance independence are different claims.

Card 2 — The unanimous chamber

Fixed facts: Every actual person sincerely approves a practice that imposes severe suffering on an excluded minority. There is no internal dissent or factual mistake.

Exact question: Does unanimity make the verdict true, provide evidence, create a standard, or merely report alignment?

Variations: Add one dissenter; include the minority in the vote; make approval informed; replace actual voters with ideally informed agents.

Inference tested: Universal agreement does not by itself identify the ground or status of a verdict.

Card 3 — The convergence machine

Fixed facts: A reliable intervention makes every person converge on the same moral judgment. It changes no nonmoral facts.

Exact question: What would convergence establish about truth?

Variations: The intervention removes factual error; removes self-interest; implants a preference; increases empathy; makes agents logically consistent.

Inference tested: Causal convergence, idealization, and truth tracking require separate warrants.

Card 4 — The missing medicine

Fixed facts: A patient needs medicine. A person who controls it refuses for no stated reason. Everyone agrees on the medical facts.

Exact question: What does “refusal is wrong” do: report, misreport, oppose, apply a rule, report a construction, or participate in a fiction?

Variations: The controller accepted a caregiving role; owns the medicine under law; needs it for another patient; rejects every moral claim.

Inference tested: Semantic function, practical force, and authority can diverge.

Card 5 — The captain’s promise

Fixed facts: A captain promises rescue, receives reliance, and later breaks the promise for convenience. The resulting loss is known.

Exact question: Which part of the criticism comes from assurance, reliance, effect, role, convention, expression, or objective obligation?

Variations: No one relied; the promise was coerced; rescue became impossible; the recipient released the captain; the promise had harmful content.

Inference tested: Similar verdicts can be supported by different meanings and relations.

Card 6 — The three cities

Fixed facts: Clockwork has a coherent, usable, cruel caste code. Harborlight has humane principles with no conflict rule. High Oracle has a complete objective truth no one can access.

Exact question: Which original specifications does each city satisfy and fail?

Variations: Give Harborlight a hidden intuitive judge; make Clockwork objectively grounded; reveal one fragment of the oracle; let citizens revise the caste code.

Inference tested: Coherence, humaneness, determinacy, accessibility, and objective truth do different work.

Card 7 — The final request

Fixed facts: A terminal patient requests an intervention. Participants disagree about the words used, prognosis, standing, value priority, attitudes, coordination, procedure, and objective truth.

Exact question: At which layer does each stated disagreement occur?

Variations: Resolve the prognosis; stipulate legal authority; change family preference; establish patient competence; make the procedure unanimous.

Inference tested: A dispute can contain eight disagreements that should not be asked to answer one another.

Part II deck — Standing, objects, values, comparison, and consistency

Card 8 — The five applicants

Fixed facts: The candidates are a silent directive that behaves intelligently, a digital navigator that reports preferences, future people, a coordinated chorus with no central subject, and a living watershed.

Exact question: Which receives direct standing, on what ground, and with what confidence?

Variations: Add credible pain reports; remove agency; add continuing identity; make ecological collapse affect no subject; establish community membership.

Inference tested: Experience, agency, interests, relationship, membership, constructed inclusion, and objective status are distinct grounds; standing is not weight.

Card 9 — The emergency sacrifice

Fixed facts: One person can be deliberately burdened to prevent severe losses to many. Effects and probabilities are known.

Exact question: Which value generates the decision and through which rule?

Variations: Change numbers; make the burden voluntary; make the person responsible for the danger; add an inviolable right; lower the probability.

Inference tested: Naming welfare, rights, or fairness does not yet specify aggregation, constraint, threshold, or exception.

Card 10 — The borrowed voice

Fixed facts: A device can reproduce a person's voice perfectly. The person refuses permission. Using it would create substantial public benefit without financial loss to them.

Exact question: What kind of value is attached to the voice—instrumental, relational, constitutive, symbolic, or protected?

Variations: The person is dead; consent was sold; the use prevents a disaster; listeners know it is synthetic; the voice carries sacred meaning.

Inference tested: Objects can matter in several ways that generate different rules.

Card 11 — The friend's answer sheet

Fixed facts: A friend asks for answers to an examination. Loyalty favors help; fair procedure and institutional trust oppose it.

Exact question: How does the system compare loyalty, relationship, honesty, and fairness?

Variations: The examination is corrupt; the friend faces expulsion; everyone cheats; the rule was hidden; help is limited to tutoring.

Inference tested: Particular relationship is not a complete priority rule.

Card 12 — Pain, extinction, and the painless edit

Fixed facts: One policy prevents intense animal pain; another prevents extinction without affecting any conscious subject; a third painlessly edits a person's preferences to remove distress.

Exact question: Which experiences, entities, identities, or forms of life have value, and of what kind?

Variations: Make the species ecologically necessary; let the person request editing; change memories; create a conscious replica; make future distress likely.

Inference tested: Welfare, identity, autonomy, ecological value, and standing can come apart.

Card 13 — Shelter disclosure

Fixed facts: A shelter protects residents from violent pursuers. Accurate public disclosure would increase transparency and enable danger.

Exact question: Is truthfulness a ban, presumption, virtue, relational demand, policy, or consequence-sensitive rule?

Variations: A resident requests disclosure; concealment hides staff abuse; the pursuer is a court; no danger remains; staff lie for convenience.

Inference tested: A value becomes action-guiding only through selectors and an exception structure.

Card 14 — Seven tollbooths

For each miniature case, hold the quantities fixed and select a comparison method.

1. A million mild headaches versus one lost eye.
2. Memory privacy versus prevention of serious injury.
3. One promise versus rescue of five strangers.
4. An irreplaceable archive versus fungible economic benefit.
5. One death versus forty recoveries.
6. Funding two unlike abilities with no common unit.
7. A valley choosing among mutually burdensome plans.

Variations: Change distribution, voluntariness, uncertainty, identity, irreversibility, or decision procedure one at a time.

Inference tested: Aggregation, priority, boundary, threshold, lexical order, plural judgment, procedure, and chosen settlement are not interchangeable.

Card 15 — Iona's vote

Fixed facts: Iona supports an exception that benefits her group. The stated rule would apply differently after an identity or power swap.

Exact question: What difference is relevant, and can it be stated before identities are revealed?

Variations: Reverse identities; reverse power; publish the rationale; repeat the exception; require compensation.

Inference tested: Consistency is relevance under stable criteria, not identical treatment or convenient symmetry.

Part III deck — Reasons, commitments, construction, and authority

Card 16 — Four agents and three reasons

Fixed facts: A lucky rescuer acts from a false belief but succeeds; a reluctant donor has strong support but little motivation; a trained prejudice motivates without truth; an unmoved witness knows the facts and feels nothing.

Exact question: What caused action, what the agent acted from, and what counts in favor?

Variations: Correct the belief; add empathy; change outcome; add social pressure; introduce an aim-independent reason.

Inference tested: Causal, motivating, evidential, and favoring relations can diverge.

Card 17 — The implanted desire

Fixed facts: Ren receives a stable desire through manipulation. It is coherent, informed, vivid, and integrated with her current identity.

Exact question: Does idealization correct the desire, accept it, or replace it through an independent value?

Variations: Ren consented beforehand; the desire benefits her; it harms others; the intervention is reversible; pre-intervention Ren opposed it.

Inference tested: "Better informed" requires selectors concerning authenticity, identity, and autonomy.

Card 18 — The lucid tyrant

Fixed facts: An agent has informed, stable, coherent aims of domination and accepts the same rule for anyone strong enough to use it.

Exact question: What consideration reaches the agent independently of his aims?

Variations: Make domination unstable; add concern for one victim; expose self-exemption; add a rational-agency premise; threaten punishment.

Inference tested: Coherence and information do not by themselves generate humane ends.

Card 19 — Commitment under strain

Fixed facts: Consider a letter promised to a dead person, a physician treating an enemy, and a rescue rule disclosed only after help was accepted.

Exact question: What creates each demand: self-governance, assurance, reliance, role, practice, symbolic honor, or objective authority?

Variations: Remove reliance; permit exit; make the role coerced; reveal deception; impose excessive cost.

Inference tested: Commitments need entry, scope, exit, emergency, mistake, exploitation, and cost clauses.

Card 20 — The tilted lottery

Fixed facts: Participants unanimously accept a lottery while bargaining power is unequal and one participant lacked meaningful exit.

Exact question: Does the procedure create legitimacy, public justifiability, coordination, or objective rightness?

Variations: Equalize power; provide information; add an outsider; use random selection; permit appeal; make agreement unanimous under coercion.

Inference tested: Procedure performs epistemic, expressive, coordinative, and constitutive jobs; fairness selectors require their own ground.

Card 21 — The unmoved antidote holder

Fixed facts: Jalen alone can provide a low-cost antidote to a dying stranger. He understands every fact and has no connected concern.

Exact question: Does the stranger's need count in favor for Jalen independently of his aims?

Variations: Jalen promised; the stranger is family; law requires aid; Jalen benefits; the rescue cost becomes high.

Inference tested: Aim-relative support, social enforcement, and aim-independent reason are different claims.

Card 22 — The forbidden song and two towns

Fixed facts: A community forbids a harmless song. Two towns adopt opposite disclosure rules. A reformer objects before the new norm gains approval.

Exact question: What do classification, pressure, law, membership, commitment, idealized criticism, and objective duty each establish?

Variations: Add harm; add a prior promise; make the outsider unaffected; make a rule unanimous; shift legal jurisdiction.

Inference tested: Social acceptance, enforcement, conditional obligation, and approval-independent authority do not form a single ascending scale.

Card 23 — The sincere interpreters

Fixed facts: Two informed communities claim the same perfect source and derive incompatible directives. Both use text, tradition, reason, and conscience.

Exact question: What identifies the source's content and corrects interpretation?

Variations: One view causes obvious harm; one has older precedent; both converge on general love; a revelation appears private; an outsider rejects the source.

Inference tested: Divine command, good nature, natural ends, and interpretive access distribute rather than erase the grounding debt.

Part IV deck — Evidence, intuition, genealogy, disagreement, and novelty

Card 24 — Seven evidential puzzles

Hold each miniature case fixed.

1. A merciful scan accurately detects illness but the patient does not seek truth.
2. A useless digit is known with perfect evidence and has no practical consequence.
3. A unanimous weather room believes a false forecast.
4. A conspiracy theorist reaches truth by luck.
5. A sealed archive contains decisive inaccessible evidence.
6. An honest placebo belief is useful but false.
7. An indifferent logician refuses an obvious implication.

Exact question: Does evidence indicate truth, serve belief, advance an aim, produce usefulness, satisfy inquiry rules, support public procedure, or supply a stance-independent epistemic reason?

Inference tested: Evidential roles should not be merged.

Card 25 — The red lever and two islands

Fixed facts: Pulling a red lever produces a strong moral seeming. Two isolated cultures have opposite certainties about the same act.

Exact question: What warrants trust in the intuition?

Variations: Add expertise; reveal framing; swap identities; train one culture differently; show transfer across novel cases; add independent evidence.

Inference tested: Seeming, confidence, salience, fluency, conceptual competence, trained perception, and insight require calibration.

Card 26 — Genealogy of a conviction

Fixed facts: A conviction reflects harm sensitivity, kinship, religion, family teaching, status incentive, historical institution, personal experience, and reflection.

Exact question: Which conclusion follows: causal explanation, local distrust, content argument, burden shift, or falsity?

Variations: Remove one influence; show counterfactual responsiveness; add independent convergence; reveal a false empirical premise; show deliberate correction.

Inference tested: Origins do not determine truth without additional premises.

Card 27 — Convergence under conquest

Fixed facts: Moral agreement rises after one culture conquers another and controls education. Later, ideal peers with shared facts still disagree.

Exact question: What kind of convergence or disagreement is present, and what should confidence do?

Variations: Remove coercion; add independent traditions; obtain case but not foundational convergence; change policy burden while inquiry continues.

Inference tested: Verbal, case, rule, foundational, and method convergence have different evidential depth.

Card 28 — The North Channel plans

Fixed facts: A city compares infrastructure plans using expected loss, anti-displacement, precaution, health priority, and procedural support. All delegates share the physical data.

Exact question: Which conclusion comes from evidence and which from a selector?

Variations: Reverse one factual estimate; hold facts and reverse a priority; remove one group's standing; change acceptable risk; change procedure.

Inference tested: Prediction is not priority, measurement is not standing, scarcity is not distribution, and risk estimate is not acceptable risk.

Card 29 — Six novel cases

1. An artificial system may be conscious.
2. A memory is edited without changing other capacities.
3. A synthetic copy claims identity continuity.
4. A policy changes which people will exist.
5. Responsibility is distributed across a remote causal network.
6. An ecosystem approaches an uncertain irreversible threshold.

Exact question: What follows under empirical uncertainty and what follows under normative uncertainty?

Variations: Change confidence, irreversibility, delay cost, standing, future identity, or appeal process one at a time.

Inference tested: Robust overlap, precaution, representation, confidence weighting, revision, and moral remainder perform different jobs.

Part V deck — The great candidates

Card 30 — The invisible village

Fixed facts: A policy maximizes total welfare while hiding that one village bears nearly all loss.

Exact question: Does the outcome rule include distribution, standing, and priority, or only a total?

Variations: Give priority to the worse off; impose sufficiency; add a right; make losses voluntary; change population.

Inference tested: Humane consequentialist repairs add selectors not supplied by maximization alone.

Card 31 — The healthy traveler

Fixed facts: Killing one healthy traveler would save five patients, remain secret, and create no further effects.

Exact question: What prohibits or permits the act?

Variations: Obtain consent; make death indirect; raise the number saved; introduce catastrophe; replace the traveler with a non-rational animal.

Inference tested: Universalization, status, rights, intention, and thresholds require content and priority rules.

Card 32 — The exhausted clerk

Fixed facts: A clerk quietly stops requesting food while formal rules prohibit abuse and aggregate outcomes appear acceptable. Caregivers are overburdened.

Exact question: What do virtue, care, relationship, and practical wisdom see that rules and totals miss?

Variations: The clerk refuses help; care becomes controlling; an outsider needs more; cultural exemplars conflict; caregiver capacity collapses.

Inference tested: Attention and relationship improve perception but do not automatically settle conflict or limits.

Card 33 — Two revelations at the harbor

Fixed facts: Two communities invoke the same divine source. One gives the last rescue place to covenant members; the other gives it to a stranger. Both have texts, traditions, and sincere interpreters.

Exact question: Which access and conflict rule identifies the received order?

Variations: Add natural-law reasoning; add institutional authority; change fruits; introduce a nonbeliever; make one interpretation recent.

Inference tested: Moving from command to good nature makes goodness and interpretation load-bearing.

Card 34 — The seawall and the unborn district

Fixed facts: A costly seawall burdens current residents, protects future people, and damages an estuary. Future people and animals cannot participate directly.

Exact question: Who enters a fair construction and through what representation?

Variations: Change veil membership; add adaptive preferences; let current consent be unanimous; change risk; give outsiders a veto.

Inference tested: Participants, idealization, representation, reasonableness, and constraints select the result.

Card 35 — Asha and the Tide People

Fixed facts: A hereditary rule excludes Asha from an archive. A majority forbids the Tide People from owning boats. Both practices are called cultural traditions.

Exact question: Which community supplies the standard, and how do reformers and internal minorities speak?

Variations: Add an equality promise; create a dissenting subcommunity; make the tradition genuinely ancient; affect outsiders; allow easy exit.

Inference tested: Culture boundaries, internal power, local validity, and approval-independent criticism should not be collapsed.

Card 36 — The evacuation of Low Harbor

Fixed facts: A cyclone threatens hospital patients, detainees, tower residents, a ceremonial archive, uncertain artificial subjects, an estuary, and exhausted rescuers. Vehicles are insufficient.

Exact question: What components and ordering rules govern a hybrid response?

Variations: Reverse political identity; change life expectancy; change artificial continuity; reveal crime records in the archive; alter ecological probability.

Inference tested: Hybrids add membership, priority, threshold, jurisdiction, and tie-breaking debts.

Part VI deck — Reform, codes, power, responsibility, and emotion

Card 37 — Caste, cover-up, and conquest

Fixed facts: One society maintains inherited caste, one unanimously exports a concealed safety risk to outsiders, and one openly values conquest without an equality promise.

Exact question: Which criticisms are factual, internal, genealogical, commitment-based, procedural, strategic, or objectively asserted?

Variations: Remove hypocrisy; include outsiders; add prior agreement; create internal dissent; make effects uncertain.

Inference tested: Effective criticism can have several grounds without every ground establishing objective condemnation.

Card 38 — The island generator

Fixed facts: One person controls the only generator, rejects rationing, and endangers medical refrigeration. The group has evidence, an emergency-sharing agreement, and lower-cost intervention options.

Exact question: What distinguishes reason-giving, bargain, coordination, legitimacy, jurisdiction, coercion, and force?

Variations: Remove the agreement; change the use from medicine to a monument; make the owner powerless; extend emergency control; add an appeal.

Inference tested: Collective necessity and power do not become objective authority; safeguards remain required.

Card 39 — Dam, clinics, and chemical fleet

Fixed facts: A democratic dam burdens outsiders; a majority closes clinics in one minority district; a wealthy fleet owner can pollute while safely evading sanctions.

Exact question: What representation, minimum protection, counterpower, and enforcement are needed?

Variations: Give outsiders a vote; disperse burdens; make the actor vulnerable to reputation; add independent review; alter jurisdiction.

Inference tested: Legitimate procedure within one constituency can coexist with domination beyond it.

Card 40 — The zero-purpose pain

Fixed facts: A deliberate saboteur is fully reformed. Protection, deterrence, restitution, rehabilitation, boundary, trust, and communication tasks are complete. Secret pain would produce no memory or effect.

Exact question: Should the pain occur solely because it is deserved?

Variations: Add deterrence; add victim demand; preserve memory; change control; make identity discontinuous.

Inference tested: Basic desert is isolated only after every other response purpose is removed.

Card 41 — Responsibility under altered conditions

Fixed facts: One offender sells memories of the act; one steals credit for a rescue; one is fully reformed; one acts under threat; one organization distributes failure across many desks.

Exact question: Which responses track causation, intention, control, risk, repair, trust, communication, system design, or payback?

Variations: Change present risk, memory continuity, organizational incentive, victim preference, and available repair separately.

Inference tested: Responsibility can remain rich after intrinsic suffering is removed.

Card 42 — Six emotional residues

1. Guilt after a faultless accident and completed repair.
2. Shame about a harmless trait.
3. Resentment after betrayal and full repair.
4. Indignation toward a vanished institution.
5. Gratitude for a controlling gift.
6. Pride in an achievement one did not help produce.

Exact question: What are the cause, appraisal, current function, audience, expression, intensity, and stopping condition?

Variations: Change danger, relationship, public audience, repair, recurrence, and desert belief one at a time.

Inference tested: An emotion can be understandable without being accurate, useful, worth expressing, or worth cultivating indefinitely.

Part VII deck — Language and policy after the search

Card 43 — The station promise

Fixed facts: Eren promises to collect Sal, knowingly goes elsewhere, gives no warning, and leaves Sal exposed to danger.

Exact question: Which language policy communicates reliance, effect, trust, protest, repair, and any objective claim?

Variations: No reliance; emergency prevented arrival; early warning; relationship ended; objective realism remains an open promissory note.

Inference tested: Abolition, fiction, conservation, expressivist revision, constructivist revision, and pragmatic translation have different risks.

Card 44 — Lark Square

Fixed facts: Serious youth assaults have risen around a square. Parents fear violence; teenagers report humiliating searches; businesses lose customers; youth programs were closed; evidence and causal models are disputed.

Exact question: How does each felt response travel through stake, fact, operational value, distribution, policy, safeguard, and review?

Variations: Change incident trend; change search yield; restore programs; alter affected testimony; reveal displacement; introduce a privacy breach.

Inference tested: Emotion reveals salience but cannot certify a factual model or move directly into law.

Card 45 — The coastal line

Fixed facts: Repeated floods threaten homeowners, renters, fishers, an Indigenous community, taxpayers, future residents, and a marsh. Barrier, relocation, and restoration policies distribute costs differently. A developer can profit from forced relocation.

Exact question: Complete a Civic Stakes Brief without granting theories seats as constituencies.

Variations: Change flood probability; compensation eligibility; marsh function; treaty authority; developer ownership; renter representation.

Inference tested: Shared values can support partial coalition while factual disagreement, priority conflict, power, and irreducible opposition remain visible.

Blank pressure card

Case title: _____

Exact question: _____

Fixed facts: _____

Tempting but excluded question: _____

Answer A: _____

Answer B: _____

One-variable variation 1: _____

One-variable variation 2: _____

One-variable variation 3: _____

What the selected answer can establish: _____

What remains open: _____

Inference tested: _____

Accept, bridge, or narrow: _____

Appendix C — Common Repairs and Their Debts

A repair is not an embarrassment. Good systems survive by repairing first formulations. The question is whether a repair supplies the missing support, moves the support to another clause, narrows the claim, or merely redescribes the gap.

Use this field guide whenever a familiar response appears. Give the response its strongest reading before entering its debt.

Repair 1 — “It is self-evident”

Strongest reading: Some truths can be known through rational reflection without inference from prior premises. A regress of justification may legitimately stop.

What it can accomplish: It states a foundational epistemology and blocks the demand that every normative claim be reduced to a nonnormative proof.

Debt created: Which proposition is self-evident? To whom? How are conceptual competence, trained intuition, cultural fluency, confidence, and genuine insight distinguished? How are conflicts among purportedly self-evident principles handled?

Pressure questions:

- Would sincere, informed disagreement reduce confidence?
- Does changing the frame or identity change the seeming?
- Does the intuition transfer to novel cases?
- What would count as a misapprehension of the basic truth?

Honest narrower form: “This proposition is a foundational commitment or seeming for me. I have not supplied an independent tracking account.”

Repair 2 — “The evidence speaks for itself”

Strongest reading: Well-calibrated evidence reliably discriminates truth from error, and serious inquiry should respond to that relation.

What it can accomplish: It can establish descriptions, causes, probabilities, consequences, and means relative to admitted ends.

Debt created: Evidence does not literally speak. Which proposition does it support, through which model and baseline? What gives evidential support normative force, if such force is claimed? Which value selects the policy after the factual estimate is known?

Pressure questions:

- Is the dispute factual, evaluative, or procedural?
- Which measurement choices affect visibility and aggregation?
- Would the same evidence support opposite policies under different values?
- Is the claim truth-directed, useful, practice-relative, publicly admissible, or objectively reason-giving?

Honest narrower form: “Under this stated method, the evidence raises confidence in factual claim F. F does not by itself select value V or rule R.”

Repair 3 — “Everyone knows”

Strongest reading: Widespread, stable convergence may be evidence when it arises through independent, truth-sensitive routes.

What it can accomplish: It can identify a shared expectation, public starting point, or candidate datum.

Debt created: Who is included in *everyone*? Is convergence verbal, case-level, rule-level, foundational, or methodological? Does it arise from common evidence, common psychology, social pressure, conquest, or truth tracking?

Pressure questions:

- Are dissenters absent, silenced, or reclassified as irrational?
- Does convergence survive fuller information and identity reversal?
- Would universal agreement constitute truth or merely accompany it?

- What happens in the unanimous harmful culture?

Honest narrower form: “This judgment is widely shared in group G under conditions C and therefore offers coordination, presumptive expectation, or defeasible evidence.”

Repair 4 — “A rational person would agree”

Strongest reading: Coherence, consistency, universalization, and the constitutive conditions of agency constrain practical judgment.

What it can accomplish: It can expose contradiction, arbitrary personal exception, means–end failure, and incoherent intention.

Debt created: Which substantive ends, standing rules, or reciprocity conditions are included in *rational*? Can a coherent tyrant satisfy the formal constraints? Does idealization correct error or replace the person’s values?

Pressure questions:

- What exact contradiction follows from rejection?
- Does the result depend on equal standing already being assumed?
- Which ideal agent is imagined?
- Can several coherent equilibria remain?

Honest narrower form: “Given ends E, information I, and consistency rule C, this agent would support R. The humane content enters through E or C as specified.”

Repair 5 — “God is goodness”

Strongest reading: Goodness is neither external to God nor arbitrarily created by command; it is identical with a necessary, perfectly loving and just nature.

What it can accomplish: It blocks the idea that any powerful command creates value and connects authority to a stable metaphysical source.

Debt created: What substantive content do *good*, *loving*, *just*, and *perfect* carry? How do interpreters identify that nature, test alleged revelation, resolve disagreement, and address outsiders? Why does creation confer moral jurisdiction?

Pressure questions:

- How is a cruel-seeming command classified as false or misunderstood?
- Does independent moral understanding test revelation?
- What distinguishes faithful development from revision?
- What reaches the informed nonbeliever?

Honest narrower form: “Within this received account, divine nature unifies our values and authority. Correct interpretation uses these declared standards and remains fallible.”

Repair 6 — “Human nature determines it”

Strongest reading: Human beings have real capacities, dependencies, vulnerabilities, and forms of flourishing that practical inquiry can study.

What it can accomplish: It supplies rich empirical content, criticizes preferences adapted to deprivation, and connects rules with needs and development.

Debt created: Which capacities define proper function? Why does a biological, psychological, or social function generate value or reason? Must each person realize every good? How are plural goods compared? What about unusual lives?

Pressure questions:

- Is *natural* descriptive, statistical, teleological, or evaluative?
- Why is disease excluded while another natural pattern is honored?
- Does flourishing already contain the favored moral traits?
- What binds an informed person who rejects the selected ideal?

Honest narrower form: “Given concern for these forms of flourishing, natural and social facts identify enabling and damaging conditions.”

Repair 7 — “Society decides”

Strongest reading: Communities create real standards, roles, expectations, procedures, and laws; public decisions are necessary under disagreement.

What it can accomplish: It explains social classification, coordination, institutional validity, enforcement, and some forms of legitimacy.

Debt created: Which society? How are overlapping communities, reformers, minorities, outsiders, and internally manufactured consent treated? Does actual decision constitute truth, legitimate action, or merely settle conduct?

Pressure questions:

- Who had voice, information, and exit?
- Does a majority control the definition of the culture?
- What protects a powerless minority?
- Can a society be criticized by its promises or only by another standard?

Honest narrower form: “Institution I authorized rule R through procedure P within jurisdiction J. This establishes legal or procedural status, not objective moral truth.”

Repair 8 — “Everything that matters can be added”

Strongest reading: A plural or hybrid system can retain consequences, rights, virtues, care, tradition, procedure, and local knowledge rather than sacrificing important human concerns to elegance.

What it can accomplish: It can produce a more perceptive, humane, stable, and corrigible practical system.

Debt created: Who chooses the components? What gives them priority? What happens in conflict? Is one component an undeclared master? Does “all things considered” hide the final selector?

Pressure questions:

- Which component wins in the evacuation case?
- What threshold permits override?
- Can two hybrids reach opposite equilibria?
- Does combination pay or merely collect the debts of the parts?

Honest narrower form: “We protect this declared plurality and settle conflict through meta-rule M, selected on basis B.”

Repair 9 — “Protect the boundary until the emergency is big enough”

Strongest reading: Rights should block ordinary sacrifice while catastrophic stakes can justify exceptional override.

What it can accomplish: It avoids both casual aggregation and disastrous absolutism.

Debt created: What defines the right, emergency, threshold, evidence standard, authorized decision-maker, duration, and repair? Does the exception preserve the principle or allow consequence to become the hidden master?

Pressure questions:

- Is one death enough? Ten? Social collapse?
- Who estimates the emergency?
- Does uncertainty lower or raise the threshold?
- Does authority expire automatically?

Honest narrower form: “We adopt a strong presumption P with public threshold T, evidence E, review R, and restoration S because we prioritize concerns V.”

Repair 10 — “Balance the values”

Strongest reading: Several incommensurable concerns may be genuine; practical judgment should respond to context without pretending they share one unit.

What it can accomplish: It preserves plural value, tragedy, residual loss, and sensitivity to cases.

Debt created: Who balances, by what method, with what calibration and appeal? Does balance settle action, express a choice, or discover an objective rank? How are power and identity prevented from becoming the scale?

Pressure questions:

- Which value may never fall below a minimum?
- What defeats a prior judgment?
- How do peer judges resolve persistent disagreement?
- What compensation acknowledges the losing concern?

Honest narrower form: “Decision-maker D uses plural criteria C and precedent P to select R, records residual loss L, and permits review under trigger T.”

Repair 11 — “Use practical wisdom”

Strongest reading: Skilled judgment perceives salience, relationship, timing, character, and context that no finite rule can encode.

What it can accomplish: It explains expertise, formation, discretion, and the need for responsive rather than mechanical action.

Debt created: Which exemplars define wisdom? How are virtue conflict, cultural difference, bias, and care-as-control corrected? Does “the wise person sees” provide a method or rename the desired answer?

Pressure questions:

- What evidence would show the expert misperceived?
- Can another admirable agent disagree?
- Which institutional review constrains discretion?
- How is wisdom formed before the learner can identify a wise teacher?

Honest narrower form: “Experienced agent A exercises bounded discretion using criteria C, reasons publicly, and remains answerable to review R.”

Repair 12 — “Suffering obviously matters”

Strongest reading: Suffering is vividly experienced, widely avoided, reliably connected to harm, and a central object of compassion.

What it can accomplish: It supplies a powerful practical starting point and directs empirical attention toward preventable injury.

Debt created: Does suffering matter to the sufferer, to compassionate agents, within a public commitment, or objectively to every agent? Who can suffer? How are intensity, number, distribution, agency, and competing values handled?

Pressure questions:

- Does a million mild pains outweigh one torture?
- What if the agent does not care?
- What about voluntary pain or painful treatment?
- Does reducing suffering permit preference editing or sacrifice?

Honest narrower form: “These beings avoid and are impaired by suffering; we care about that stake and design policy to reduce it under distribution and agency constraints.”

Repair 13 — “Evolution or culture explains the belief”

Strongest reading: A belief-forming process may track survival, conformity, kinship, or status rather than truth, shifting the burden onto a tracking account.

What it can accomplish: It can explain confidence, expose irrelevant cues, undermine a local process, or support a burden shift.

Debt created: What additional premise connects origin to falsity? Could truth coincide with adaptiveness? Did reflection correct the initial process? Is there an independent route?

Pressure questions:

- Is the argument causal, process-level, content-level, or burden-level?
- Would a different formation history change the belief?
- Does the genealogy bear on truth or only confidence?
- Could the same challenge debunk the skeptic’s values?

Honest narrower form: “This genealogy lowers trust in process P unless an independent truth-sensitive route is shown. It does not by itself establish that proposition F is false.”

Repair 14 — “People disagree, so there is no truth”

Strongest reading: Persistent informed disagreement may be unexpected under a theory that predicts clear, shared access to determinate truth.

What it can accomplish: It can challenge an access claim, reduce confidence, reveal indeterminacy, or motivate procedural settlement.

Debt created: Why should truth produce convergence here? Are peers equally informed and independent? Is disagreement about fact, standing, priority, commitment, procedure, or objective truth?

Pressure questions:

- Do other true domains contain disagreement?
- Does consensus result from shared formation?
- Would idealization converge or produce several equilibria?
- What policy follows while confidence remains divided?

Honest narrower form: “This disagreement is evidence against access hypothesis H to degree D; it does not entail error theory.”

Repair 15 — “A fair vote settles it”

Strongest reading: Accountable procedure enables coordination and peaceful revision among people who cannot agree on substance.

What it can accomplish: It can create legitimate settlement within a constituency, distribute authorship, and make power answerable.

Debt created: Who participates, who is represented, what constraints apply, and what reaches outsiders? Does the result establish procedural validity or moral truth?

Pressure questions:

- Does the majority concentrate severe cost on a minority?
- Who set the agenda?
- Can future people or animals be represented?
- What may no ordinary majority do?

Honest narrower form: “Procedure P authorizes temporary settlement R among constituency C, subject to protections S and revision T.”

Repair 16 — “The law creates the obligation”

Strongest reading: Legal systems constitute offices, permissions, prohibitions, expectations, and sanctions that would not exist without institutions.

What it can accomplish: It explains legal status, jurisdiction, coordination, and practical consequences.

Debt created: Does legal validity create prudential, role-relative, agreement-based, or objective moral support? What makes the institution legitimate? How are unjust or outsider-burdening laws criticized?

Pressure questions:

- Would a procedurally valid caste law be morally authoritative?
- Does fear of sanction count in favor or merely motivate?
- What permits civil disobedience?
- Where does jurisdiction end?

Honest narrower form: “Law L validly governs domain D and creates consequences C. Its legitimacy and objective authority require separate arguments.”

Repair 17 — “The person deserves it”

Strongest reading: Desert recognizes agency, protects victims, limits punishment to the responsible, and supports proportionality.

What it can accomplish: It focuses attention on knowledge, intention, control, identity, and relation to the act.

Debt created: Which response purpose requires suffering as such? What makes a quantity proportional? How do identity change, coercion, reform, and system causation alter desert?

Pressure questions:

- Would zero-purpose secret pain improve the situation?
- Have protection, repair, trust, and communication already completed their jobs?
- Does victim recognition require offender suffering?
- When does the response stop?

Honest narrower form: “We impose response R for named purpose P under safeguard S and stopping condition T. Any remaining suffering-for-its-own-sake is labeled retribution.”

Repair 18 — “Without objective morality, anything goes”

Strongest reading: People fear losing criticism, law, responsibility, motivation, and protection if no stance-independent authority exists.

What it can accomplish: It correctly identifies practical functions that any replacement must preserve or consciously revise.

Debt created: The inference assumes that only objective facts can support action and institutions. Which phenomenon actually disappears: pain, concern, agreement, law, evidence, power, protest, or universal authority?

Pressure questions:

- Do values and institutions cease to exist?
- Does egoism become objectively true?
- Why would preference strengths become equal?
- Can a society enforce a charter without cosmic certification?

Honest narrower form: “Without objective authority, no policy is guaranteed to bind every rejecter. We still act through concerns, commitments, agreements, institutions, and power, which require explicit limits.”

Blank repair card

Repair offered: _____

Strongest reading: _____

What it genuinely accomplishes: _____

Original debt addressed: _____

New or relocated debt: _____

Pressure question 1: _____

Pressure question 2: _____

Pressure question 3: _____

Honest narrower form: _____

Appendix D — The Civic Stakes Brief

The Civic Stakes Brief is a reusable public-policy template for controversies in which factual uncertainty, divergent values, institutional power, and affected lives interact. It does not certify objective moral truth. It makes a proposal answerable to its declared purposes, evidence, constituencies, tradeoffs, safeguards, and revision conditions.

Complete the brief before a final vote or coercive implementation. Preserve every version. Do not replace dissent with “the community believes.”

Use rules

1. Start with reported experience and concrete stakes, not theory labels.
2. Separate factual claims from standing, priority, settlement, and authority.
3. Treat emotion as evidence of salience and appraisal, not automatic evidence that the appraisal is accurate.
4. State the comparison method whenever values conflict.
5. Name coercion and force rather than hiding them inside *implementation*.
6. Give every extraordinary power a scope, review, and expiration.
7. State what would reduce confidence in the policy.
8. Preserve the views of affected dissenters.
9. Plan repair before the institution discovers its first error.
10. Translate any high-stakes use of *right*, *wrong*, *just*, *duty*, or *desert* into the components below.

Cover page

Decision title: _____

Brief version: _____

Date: _____

Decision date: _____

Preparing institution: _____

Named authors and roles: _____

Affected-party contributors: _____

Independent reviewers: _____

Public location of evidence and prior versions: _____

Current status: *exploration / pilot / proposed / authorized / active / under review / expired:* _____

1. Decision and jurisdiction

Exact decision: _____

Options currently open: _____

Decision-maker: _____

Legal or institutional authority: _____

Geographic scope: _____

Population or subject-matter scope: _____

Start and end dates: _____

Matters outside this decision: _____

Authority that could reverse or review it: _____

Jurisdiction check

- ☐ The decision-maker’s authority over insiders is stated.
- ☐ Effects outside the jurisdiction are identified.

- ☐ Emergency authority is separated from ordinary authority.
- ☐ Legal validity is not presented as objective moral correctness.

2. Affected parties and standing

List parties before ranking their claims.

Party or system	Direct effect	Indirect effect	Can participate?	Proposed ground of standing	Confidence	Representative or evidence source

Check explicitly for:

- ☐ residents without formal membership;
- ☐ children or dependents;
- ☐ people with limited communication;
- ☐ future people;
- ☐ people outside the jurisdiction;
- ☐ nonhuman animals;
- ☐ ecosystems;
- ☐ artificial subjects of uncertain status;
- ☐ workers who implement the policy;
- ☐ people vulnerable to official error.

Who remains unrepresented and why: _____

How uncertainty about standing changes the policy: _____

3. Emotional stakes and reported experience

Do not infer facts from emotion without a separate evidential route.

Party	Reported emotion or response	Object or trigger	Appraisal contained	Current function	Possible distortion or strategic use	How testimony was gathered

Prompts:

- What are people afraid will happen?
- What loss does grief register?
- What boundary does anger protect?
- What humiliation or domination is reported?
- Which attachment or identity is threatened?
- Which hope sustains support?
- Whose emotional report is dismissed as irrational, and by whom?
- Which fear or indignation is being amplified for advantage?

Responses that reveal a new stake: _____

Appraisals requiring factual testing: _____

Emotions that should not be turned directly into policy: _____

4. Operational values

Translate abstract values into states, experiences, capacities, relationships, or practices.

Value label	Operational meaning	Bearer	Desired direction	Minimum, target, or protected boundary	Evidence relevant to application
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Examples of required translation:

- *Safety* → protection from which event, at what probability and time?
- *Freedom* → which action, option, or protection from whose control?
- *Dignity* → which treatment, recognition, bodily boundary, or social condition?
- *Fairness* → which distribution, procedure, reciprocity, or status relation?
- *Community* → which people, practices, attachments, and boundaries?

Whose values these are: _____

Who rejects or gives low priority to them: _____

Objective status claimed, if any, and warrant: _____

5. Empirical claims and confidence

Claim	Type: description, cause, forecast, or measurement	Evidence	Method and baseline	Confidence	Main uncertainty	Evidence that would reduce confidence

Audit:

- ☐ Operational definitions are public.
- ☐ Missing cases and invisible populations are considered.
- ☐ Aggregation choices are stated.
- ☐ Classification thresholds are stated.
- ☐ Model objectives and incentives are disclosed.
- ☐ Affected testimony and administrative data are compared.
- ☐ Correlation is not presented as cause without a method.
- ☐ Evidence can change the proposal rather than merely decorate it.

Truth-responsive route used: _____

What evidence settles: _____

What evidence leaves open: standing / priority / acceptable risk / distribution / procedure / objective status / other: _____

6. Comparison method and unresolved conflicts

Conflict	Bearers	Distribution	Method selected	Selector or decision-maker	Residual loss	Dissent

Available methods:

- common-scale aggregation;
- priority to the worse off;
- protected minimum or boundary;
- emergency threshold;
- lexical priority;
- disciplined plural judgment;
- fair procedure;
- negotiated or chosen settlement.

Why this method was chosen: _____

What the method claims: *objective rank / public legitimacy / coordination / practical choice / other:* _____

Tie rule: _____

Conflict left genuinely unresolved: _____

Compensation, apology, restoration, or acknowledgment of residue: _____

7. Available resources and constraints

Resource	Available amount	Owner or controller	Timing	Competing use	Reliability or uncertainty
Money	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Personnel	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Time	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Land or physical space	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Infrastructure	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Information	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Admin. capacity	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Opportunity costs: _____

Scarcity that cannot be removed during the decision: _____

Who bears delay: _____

8. Power and enforcement

Draw the power map.

Actor	Can decide	Can delay	Can enforce	Can evade	Can set agenda	Can gather evidence	Can appeal	Main dependency or counterpower

Conduct constrained: _____

Coercion or force authorized: _____

Evidence threshold: _____

Maximum permitted intrusion: _____

People most vulnerable to error or selective enforcement: _____

Actor who can safely defect: _____

Counterpower and independent review: _____

9. Policy alternatives

Include a real baseline and at least three alternatives.

Option	Mechanism	Values served	Parties benefited	Parties burdened	Evidence	Power required	Reversibility	Cost
Current course / no action								
Noncoercive support								
Pilot or limited intervention								
Regulatory or coercive intervention								
Hybrid								

Option excluded before analysis and why: _____

Policy chosen: _____

Why this option rather than the nearest alternative: _____

10. Safeguards

Predictable failure or abuse	Safeguard	Responsible actor	Verification	Appeal	Trigger for suspension
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Consider:

- protected minimums;
- evidence and notice requirements;
- least-intrusive means;
- representation of concentrated losers;
- conflict-of-interest rules;
- privacy and data-use limits;
- independent review;
- public reasons and records;
- appeal;
- compensation;
- minority protection;
- expiration;
- restoration after emergency.

Safeguard value: _____

Who supports it and why: _____

Who can disable it: _____

11. Measures

Measure	Value or factual claim tracked	Distribution reported	Data owner	Frequency	Manipulation risk	Interpretation limit

Include where relevant:

- outcome and severity;
- process and participation;
- distribution across groups;
- false positives and false negatives;
- displacement to another location or population;
- reported experience;
- cost and opportunity cost;
- rights or boundary violations;
- official complaints and established errors;
- unmeasured or poorly measured stakes.

Measure that could look successful while the policy fails: _____

Stake not captured well by available measures: _____

12. Review, failure, and sunset

Initial review date: _____

Full redesign date: _____

Automatic expiration: _____

Who can trigger early review: _____

Evidence of success: _____

Evidence of partial success: _____

Failure condition: _____

Unacceptable collateral effect: _____

What remains protected during review: _____

Procedure for continuation: _____

13. Error acknowledgment and repair

Plan before the error occurs.

Possible error	Person or system affected	Notice	Record correction	Compensation or restoration	Institutional change	Public acknowledgment

Responsible office: _____
 Funding reserved for repair: _____
 Time limit for response: _____
 Appeal when repair is denied: _____

14. Support and dissent statement

Actor or group	Supports, opposes, or uncertain	Actual basis	Desired change	Power in final decision
_____	_____	shared value / interest / commitment / agreement / role / procedure / prediction / objective claim / other: _____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Overlapping support from different values: _____
 Shared value with disputed factual model: _____
 Shared facts with disputed priority: _____
 Irreducible conflict: _____
 Permanent dissenter: _____
 What will be enforced despite dissent: _____
 Objective authority claimed, if any, and warrant: _____

Final decision record

Selected policy: _____
 Date and vote or authorizing act: _____
 Declared goals: _____
 Primary evidence: _____
 Comparison method: _____
 Main burden and bearer: _____
 Principal safeguard: _____
 Review and expiration: _____
 Dissent preserved: _____
 Repair commitment: _____
 Clause asserted as objectively required: _____
 Ground and access route for that clause: _____

Independent reviewer page

Ask at least three reviewers to mark one entry in each category.

Invisible party: _____
 Misclassified standing claim: _____
 Emotion treated as factual proof: _____
 Unsupported factual claim: _____
 Hidden comparison rule: _____
 Underestimated cost or distribution: _____
 Unmapped power: _____

Safeguard vulnerable to capture: _____

Metric that can be gamed: _____

Missing failure condition: _____

Repair omitted: _____

Objective language exceeding its warrant: _____

Reviewer standpoint and relevant interests: _____

What this review leaves open: _____

One-page public summary

We are deciding _____ under authority _____. The people and systems most affected are _____. They report stakes including _____. The policy protects or advances _____, based on factual claims _____ with confidence _____. The principal unresolved conflict is _____, settled through _____. The largest burden falls on _____. Implementation gives power to _____ and constrains _____. Safeguards include _____. We will measure _____, review on _____, and end or redesign the policy if _____. Established errors will be addressed through _____. Support comes from _____; dissent remains from _____. The proposal is presented as factual / instrumental / expressive / commitment-based / agreement-based / procedural / enforced / objectively required: _____.